

Aging in Place & Independent Living

Learner guide | SWP-010 | School of Gerontology & Aging Services

This guide supports a three-part learning sequence for Aging in Place & Independent Living. By the end of the course, you should be able to assess and support safe, dignified independent living for older adults.

Practice notice: Apply the law, organisational policy, supervision requirements, and approved referral pathways that govern your setting. This material supports learning and does not replace urgent safeguarding, clinical, or legal procedures.

Learning objectives

- Assess and support safe, dignified independent living for older adults.
- Apply the key ideas from Person-centred ageing.
- Apply the key ideas from Home and community assessment.
- Apply the key ideas from Coordinated ageing-in-place plan.

Course structure

Module	Focus	Suggested study time
1. Person-centred ageing	autonomy, capacity, culture, rights, and social determinants	10 to 15 minutes
2. Home and community assessment	falls, accessibility, medication/health supports, isolation, and caregiver capacity	10 to 15 minutes
3. Coordinated ageing-in-place plan	services, technology, family collaboration, review, and safeguarding	10 to 15 minutes

Module 1 Person-centred ageing

This module focuses on autonomy, capacity, culture, rights, and social determinants. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Autonomy
- Capacity
- Culture
- Rights
- Social determinants

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of person-centred ageing in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of autonomy, capacity, culture, rights, and social determinants. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through person-centred ageing safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 2 Home and community assessment

This module focuses on falls, accessibility, medication/health supports, isolation, and caregiver capacity. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Falls
- Accessibility
- Medication/health supports
- Isolation
- Caregiver capacity

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of home and community assessment in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of falls, accessibility, medication/health supports, isolation, and caregiver capacity. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through home and community assessment safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 3 Coordinated ageing-in-place plan

This module focuses on services, technology, family collaboration, review, and safeguarding. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Services
- Technology
- Family collaboration
- Review
- Safeguarding

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of coordinated ageing-in-place plan in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of services, technology, family collaboration, review, and safeguarding. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through coordinated ageing-in-place plan safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Course activity

Use the accompanying worksheet to apply the course sequence to a short case. Your completed activity should show what you noticed, the action you would take within your role, and what you would escalate or verify locally.

Assessment preparation

- Review the distinction between: risk factors.
- Review the distinction between: autonomy.
- Review the distinction between: supports.
- Review the distinction between: review.

References and local adaptation

- SWEEP Academy Course Content Outlines, production blueprint for this course.
- The current legislation, professional standards, safeguarding procedures, and referral directories for the delivery jurisdiction.
- The learner's employer or placement policy, supervision arrangements, and documentation standards.